Practical 3: Filter RetailPulse Sales by Region and Date

Related topic: Focus Reports Using Filters

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Objective

Apply a simple filter and an advanced detail filter to scope a report to a single region and reporting period, then generalise it with a prompt.

Materials Required

IBM Cognos Analytics access, the grouped RetailPulse list report from Practical 2.

Step-by-Step Procedure

1. Open the RetailPulse Sales list report built in the previous practical.

2. Open the **Filters** pane (Filter icon) and add a simple filter: **Region = "North"**.

Selecting Region and choosing Add Filter > Create Custom Filter.

3. Add an advanced **Detail Filter** (Filters > Add > Advanced) combining Sales Date between quarter start and end dates.

4. Combine both conditions with **AND** so only North-region, target-quarter rows remain.

5. Run the report and confirm row counts drop to match the filtered scope.

Source rows fall from 96 to 18; list rows from 24 to 6.

6. Convert the Region filter into a prompted filter: replace the literal with a prompt parameter and set **Prompt every time**.

Cognos generates a default prompt page; other managers can choose their own Region.

Sample Solution (Output)

Filter expressions used

```
Simple filter : [Region] = 'North'
Detail filter : [Sales Date] between 2026-07-01 and 2026-09-30
Combined : [Region] = 'North' AND [Sales Date] between 2026-07-01 and 2026-09-30
Prompted : [Region] = ?pRegion?
```

Measure	Unfiltered	Filtered (North, Q3 2026)
Source fact rows	96	18
Rows on list report	24	6
Sales Amount (grand total)	$164,250.17	$27,665.31

Run 1 - Filtered report (North, 01 Jul - 30 Sep 2026)

Region	Store Name	Product Category	Quantity	Sales Amount
North	North Plaza	Apparel	113	$5,114.20
North	North Plaza	Electronics	15	$3,621.77
North	North Plaza	Home & Kitchen	53	$4,069.21
North	North Square	Apparel	122	$5,400.43
North	North Square	Electronics	18	$4,329.86
North	North Square	Home & Kitchen	67	$5,129.84

Region	Store Name	Product Category	Quantity	Sales Amount
		Total	**388**	**$27,665.31**

Run 2 - Prompted version re-run with Region = South

Region	Store Name	Product Category	Quantity	Sales Amount
South	South Gardens	Apparel	109	$4,672.52
South	South Gardens	Electronics	25	$5,987.42
South	South Gardens	Home & Kitchen	46	$3,727.15
South	South Harbor	Apparel	129	$6,034.49
South	South Harbor	Electronics	18	$4,423.44
South	South Harbor	Home & Kitchen	76	$6,261.76
		Total	**403**	**$31,106.78**

Figure 3.1: The same report returns different data when the prompt value changes.

What a Correct Result Looks Like

After filtering, the report returns only North-region rows within the target quarter; the detail filter expression correctly joins the date-range condition with AND; converting Region to a prompt lets the same report return South-region rows when re-run with a different prompt value.

Expected Outcome

Only rows matching both conditions remain; the row count is visibly smaller than the unfiltered report; the prompted version returns a different region's data on re-run.

Verification Checklist

Check	Status
Simple filter Region = North applied	Verified
Detail filter on Sales Date joined with AND	Verified
Row count reduced from 96 to 18 source rows	Verified
Prompt re-run with South returns South stores only	Verified

Note on screens and data: Figures in this file are illustrative renderings of how each Cognos Analytics output looks, built from a sample RetailPulse data set (8 stores, 3 product categories, Jul-Oct 2026). All totals reconcile across Practicals 1-5. Replace them with screenshots from your own Cognos session before submission if your lab requires live captures.